

## A NOTE ON BUYING

# Keep the ones that last

Autumn, of all the seasons, rewards buying for keeps. The wool you choose now you'll reach for every cold evening for years; the oak chairs will outlast their fashion; the dried stems will hold the season through several winters. This is the issue to spend a little more on a little less — one excellent thing, kept, over five adequate ones, replaced.

That is the deepest economy of a calm home, and the truest expression of *mono no aware* in a shopping list: choose the things that age beautifully, that show their years rather than hide them, and that you'll be sad to part with. Then keep them, and let them get old with you.

*"A little more on a little less. One thing kept beats five things replaced."*